

# CHRISTIAAN HUYGENS

1629-1695

Huygens also  
invented  
the **pendulum  
clock** and the  
**pocket watch**.



In 1659, Huygens published  
the idea that Saturn was  
surrounded by a flat ring

Dutch astronomer Christiaan Huygens developed lenses that made telescopes more powerful. In 1655, he spotted dark markings on Mars, and discovered the planet was spinning. He also discovered the rings around the planet Saturn, but he did not know what they were made of.

## DATA FILE



**KEY DISCOVERY:** Established that Saturn was surrounded by rings



**COUNTRY OF ORIGIN:**  
The Netherlands



**YEAR OF DISCOVERY:** 1655